

SETUP GUIDE · FREE & OPEN SOURCE

Build your own *JARVIS* on your laptop

Tony Stark spent a billion dollars on his. You need one GitHub repo, about 30 minutes, and zero rupees. This guide takes you from nothing to a personal AI assistant that reads your inbox and calendar and talks to you every morning.

Repo github.com/open-jarvis/OpenJarvis

License Apache-2.0

Runs locally on your machine

BEFORE YOU START

What you're building

OpenJarvis is an open-source framework from Stanford for **local-first personal AI**. The AI model runs on your own hardware, and cloud APIs are optional. It comes with ready-made agents, a chat UI, a desktop app, voice, and connectors for Gmail, Calendar, Slack, Notion and more.

1	2	3	4	5
Install with Claude Code (or one command)	Run a local model with Ollama	Give it a voice	Connect your tools	Get your morning brief

You'll need

☐ A laptop: macOS, Linux, or Windows (native or WSL2). 16 GB RAM is comfortable; a 4B model works on 8 GB.

☐ ~10 GB free disk space for the model.

☐ Optional: **Claude Code** (or any AI coding agent) for the copy-paste install.

☐ Optional: a Google account to connect Gmail and Calendar.

> **Why "local" matters**
> Your emails are read by a model on *your* machine, and no company can start charging you later.

01 Install it

Option A: let Claude Code do it (what I showed in the reel)

Open Claude Code in an empty folder and paste this prompt:

```
> Clone https://github.com/open-jarvis/OpenJarvis and install it on this
  machine. Follow the README, install Ollama and a small local model if
  missing, run the quickstart, and tell me when `jarvis` works.
```

It downloads, installs, and fixes most errors itself. Read each command before you approve it.

Option B: one command yourself

```
# macOS · Linux · WSL2
curl -fsSL https://open-jarvis.github.io/OpenJarvis/install.sh | bash

# Native Windows (PowerShell)
irm https://open-jarvis.github.io/OpenJarvis/install.ps1 | iex
```

Prefer a normal app? Download the desktop build for macOS, Windows or Linux from the repo's **Releases** page. On macOS, if it says the app is "damaged", run `xattr -cr /Applications/OpenJarvis.app`.

02 Start chatting with a local model

OpenJarvis detects your GPU/CPU and recommends an engine. The simplest path is **Ollama**.

```
# pull a model (the 4B one runs on almost any laptop)
ollama pull qwen3.5:4b        # or qwen3.5:9b if you have 16 GB+ RAM

# talk to it
jarvis                        # chat in the terminal
jarvis gui                    # chat in the browser
jarvis ask "Summarise what OpenJarvis can do in 3 lines"
```

Your settings live in `~/.openjarvis/config.toml`. The fastest way to get a working config is a **preset**:

PRESET	WHAT IT SETS UP
`morning-digest-minimal`	Ollama + Gmail + Calendar briefing. **Start here.**
`morning-digest-mac` / `-linux`	Fuller briefing with more sections
`chat-simple`	Plain chat assistant
`deep-research`	Research agent with web search
`code-assistant`	Code review / coding helper
`scheduled-monitor`	Agent that checks things on a schedule

```
jarvis init --preset morning-digest-minimal --force
```

> **Heads-up**
> `--force` replaces your existing config file. Back up `~/.openjarvis/config.toml` first if you've edited it.

03 Give it a voice

In the reel I said "grab a voice key from ElevenLabs". Here's the exact situation, so you don't get stuck:

VOICE BACKEND	COST	HOW
Kokoro (built in)	Free, runs locally	`pip install kokoro`, then set `tts_backend = "kokoro"`. Voice `bm_george` is a British male, the closest to JARVIS.
OpenAI (built in)	Paid API	Set `OPENAI_API_KEY`; voice `onyx`.
Cartesia (built in)	Paid API, free tier	Set `CARTESIA_API_KEY` and a `voice_id` from Cartesia.
ElevenLabs	Free tier / paid	**Not built in yet.** Pick a voice in the ElevenLabs Voice Library, copy your API key and voice ID, and ask Claude Code to *"add an ElevenLabs TTS backend to OpenJarvis, next to cartesia_tts.py"*. That's the "plug it in" step.

Edit the `[digest]` block in `~/.openjarvis/config.toml`:

```
[digest]
persona     = "jarvis"
honorific   = "sir"          # or your name
tts_backend = "kokoro"
voice_id    = "bm_george"
```

> **Keep keys secret**
> API keys go in environment variables, never in screenshots, repos or reels. If one leaks, revoke it.

Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	FIX
A brief section is empty	`jarvis connect --list`; reconnect anything expired.
No audio	Check the TTS key / that `kokoro` is installed; use `--text-only` meanwhile.
Slow or out of memory	Switch to a smaller model, e.g. `qwen3.5:4b`, in `[intelligence] default_model`.
Weather not showing	New OpenWeatherMap keys take ~2 hours to activate.
GitHub 403	The token needs the account-level `notifications` permission.

04 Connect your tools

Each connector opens a browser login (OAuth). Your tokens are stored locally under `~/.openjarvis/`.

```
jarvis connect gdrive      # Gmail + Google Calendar + Tasks + Drive in one login
jarvis connect slack
jarvis connect outlook
jarvis connect notion
jarvis connect --list      # see what's connected / expired
```

Other connectors include Obsidian, Dropbox, Spotify, Strava, Oura, Granola, Apple Calendar/Contacts/Health, and Gmail over IMAP. Weather, GitHub and RSS use small JSON key files in `~/.openjarvis/connectors/`; see the Morning Digest page in the docs.

05 Your morning brief

This is the "40 emails → three things that matter" part. The digest agent reads your sources and tells you what's pending, what's important, and who's still waiting on a reply.

```
jarvis digest --fresh             # build + speak today's brief now
jarvis digest --text-only         # no audio, just read it
jarvis digest --schedule "0 7 * * *"   # every day at 7:00 AM
jarvis digest --schedule off      # stop the schedule
```

Choose what goes into the brief in the config:

```
[digest]
sections = ["messages", "calendar"]
timezone = "Asia/Kolkata"

[digest.messages]
sources = ["gmail", "slack"]

[digest.calendar]
sources = ["gcalendar"]
```

CHEAT SHEET

Everything on one page

```
# 1. install
curl -fsSL https://open-jarvis.github.io/OpenJarvis/install.sh | bash
#    Windows: irm https://open-jarvis.github.io/OpenJarvis/install.ps1 | iex

# 2. model + preset
ollama pull qwen3.5:4b
jarvis init --preset morning-digest-minimal --force

# 3. voice (free, local)
pip install kokoro
#    config.toml → [digest] tts_backend = "kokoro", voice_id = "bm_george"

# 4. connect
jarvis connect gdrive

# 5. go
jarvis digest --fresh
jarvis digest --schedule "0 7 * * *"
jarvis gui
```

Try these next

- `jarvis init --preset deep-research --force`: a research agent that searches and cites.
- `jarvis memory index ./notes/` then `jarvis memory search "…"`: chat with your own notes.
- `jarvis skill install hermes:arxiv`: add skills from the public skill libraries.

Links

- Repo: github.com/open-jarvis/OpenJarvis
- Docs: open-jarvis.github.io/OpenJarvis
- Project site: openjarvis.stanford.edu
- Morning digest guide: docs → User Guide → Morning Digest

> **Stuck?**
> Paste the exact error into Claude Code (or ChatGPT) along with the command you ran. That fixes 90% of install problems faster than any forum.

Built it? Share it with a developer friend, and tag @aiburner_official.

OpenJarvis is an independent open-source project (Apache-2.0); this guide is not affiliated with it, Stanford, Marvel or any of the services mentioned. Commands were checked against the public repo in October 2026; if something has changed, the README is the source of truth.